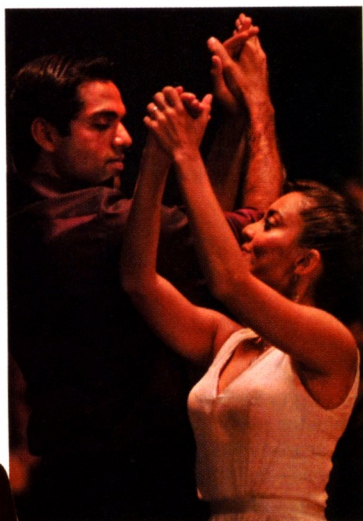


and Tips's discovery, Urvashi Sharma, who will be seen in a sensuous salsa sequence in Abbas-Mustan's forthcoming thriller *Naqaab*. Says director Mustan, "We were sure that we wanted to include a salsa number in the film because it is a very sensuous and passionate form of dance where the actors can convey emotions through their performance. So we asked music director Pritam to compose a Spanish tune for the number *Ek Din*." Choreographed by Raju Khan, the number will see Khanna in a Latin-dancer look, styled by Falguni Thakore.



HOTSTEPPERS: Akshaye, Urvashi salsa in *Naqaab* (below). Abhay and Minnisha (left) in *Honeymoon Travels*.

While choreographers like Khan draw reference from ballroom moves and are bringing a new flavour to Bollywood's dance ditties, old timers are fast catching up with this new trend in an attempt to keep up with the times. Choreographer-turned-filmmaker Farah Khan judged many intricate sequences of ballroom dancing on Sony Entertainment Television's *Jhalak Dikhhla Jaa* and was inspired to go to the show's technical director Soparrkar for a "refresher" course to brush up her skills. Now, even the original pelvic thrust pioneer Govinda is learning ballroom dance from instructors Chow and Mow as a hobby. While Kajol slipped into harem pants and made a special appearance at Soparrkar's International Dance Day celebrations in April, she, Manisha Koirala, Mallika Sherawat, Sonali Bendre and Dino Morea are picking up dance moves at his studio. "Actors like Amisha Patel, Koena Mitra and Shamita Shetty have also shown interest. And they want to do it to enjoy and learn a new dance form," he says.

And while learning and competing might be one thing, there are those like television actors Mona Singh, Shweta Salve and bombshell Pooja Bedi, who have made a business of live shows and music videos. Pooja Bedi and choreographer Ilanif Hilal got booted from *Jhalak Dikhhla Jaa* in the initial rounds, but they are more than making up for their early exit by doing live shows and shooting a music video for DJ Notorious, which has made quite a splash with "a mix of rumba, salsa and samba" thrown in. Choreographed by Longines Fernandes, who partnered Shweta Salve on the Sony dance show, here is a fine example of Latin magic moving into mainstream music videos.

Even as Bollywood's beauties and leading men learn to twist, shift and swivel with precision and élan, you can expect to see more ballroom dance styles waltzing and jiving across your screens. And as shimmy-shaking sirens like Shakira and Pooja Bedi will tell you, hips definitely don't lie. ■



BOLLYWOOD ON THE BALL

Waltz

The slow waltz works perfectly for romantic sequences in period films with grand ballrooms and flowing evening gowns.

Rumba

The rumba is extremely sensual and conveys love. It suits the portrayal of romance and passion in Hindi films.

Salsa

This dance form is hot, happening and youthful. Salsa fits well in club and party sequences in Bollywood movies.

Jive

Jive and cha-cha work somewhat similarly and gel well with Hindi film music. Are perfect for old movie remakes.

Tango

Raw passion and sensuality come alive in the tango, perfect for a typical Bollywood seduction scene.